Seed Starting Log

A friendly getting-started guide

Starting seeds indoors is where the season really begins. This log keeps track of what you planted, when, and how it did — so next year you know exactly what to repeat and what to skip.

How to use it

1. **Find your frost dates first.** Write your average *last spring frost* and *first fall frost* in the slots at the top. A quick web search for "frost dates" plus your zip code will find them; your local extension office knows too.
2. **Count backwards.** Most seed packets say something like "start indoors 6–8 weeks before last frost." Use the frost-date slots to figure out your actual sowing date.
3. **Log every tray.** One row per variety: what you planted, the date, how many cells, and when sprouts appeared.
4. **Note the outcome.** Did it sprout fast? Damp off? Get leggy? That note is gold next winter.

> **Beginner tip:** Seeds need warmth more than light to sprout, but seedlings need serious light the moment they emerge. A sunny window is often not enough — a cheap shop light kept 2 inches above the plants works wonders.

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My average last spring frost date: _____ **My average first fall frost date:** _____

6 weeks before last frost = _____ **8 weeks before last frost =** _____

CROP / VARIETY	SOWN DATE	WEEKS BEFORE FROST	# CELLS	GERMINATED	TRANSPLANTED	NOTES (SPROUT VIGOR, PROBLEMS, WINS)

Copy this sheet as many times as you need — one per tray batch works well.